

Identify and Remove Suspicious Browser Extensions

Task 7: Identify and Remove Suspicious Browser Extensions.

Objective:

- Learn to spot and remove potentially harmful browser extensions.

Tools:

- Any web browser (e.g., Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox).

Deliverables:

- List of suspicious extensions found and removed (if any).
- Documentation of steps taken.

Mini Guide / Steps:

- Open your browser's extension or add-ons manager.
- Chrome: *Menu > More tools > Extensionz*
- Firefox: *Menu > Add-ons and themes > Extensions*
- Review all installed extensions carefully.
- Check permissions (e.g., "Read and change all data on websites") and user reviews for each extension.
- Identify any extensions that are unused, unnecessary, or suspicious.
- Remove or disable those extensions.
- Restart the browser and observe if performance or security improves.
- Research how malicious extensions can harm users (e.g., data theft, ad injections).\
- Document steps taken and list the extensions removed.

Interview Questions:

- How can browser extensions pose security risks?
- What permissions should raise suspicion in an extension?
- How can users safely install browser extensions?
- What is extension sandboxing, and why is it important?
- Can extensions steal stored passwords?
- How should extensions be updated securely?
- What is the difference between extensions and plugins?
- How can malicious extensions be reported to browser vendors?

Key Concepts:

- Browser security
- Extensions and add-ons
- Permissions and access levels
- Malware in extensions
- Security best practices